CEE6501 — Lecture 9.1

Temperature Changes and Fabrication Errors

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lecture, you will be able to:

- Explain why temperature changes and fabrication errors generate internal forces in statically indeterminate structures
- Compute the local end displacement vector caused by a temperature gradient
- Derive local fixed-end force vectors due to temperature changes
- Distinguish between uniform temperature change and temperature gradient effects
- Compute fixed-end forces caused by fabrication errors in member length and member straightness
- Incorporate $\mathbf{q}_i^H$ and $\mathbf{q}_i^E$ into the DSM workflow

Agenda

- **Part 1** — Temperature Changes: Conceptual Framework
- **Part 2** — Temperature Changes: Simply Supported Member
- **Part 3** — Temperature Changes: Fixed-End Forces
- **Part 4** — Fabrication Errors: Conceptual Framework
- **Part 5** — Fabrication Errors: Fixed-End Force Expressions
- **Part 6** — DSM Implementation and Wrap-Up

Part 1 — Temperature Changes Conceptual Framework

Why Temperature Changes Matter

Like support settlements, temperature changes can induce significant stresses in a structure.

If a member were completely free, it would simply:

- expand or contract axially, and/or
- bend due to a temperature gradient through its depth.

But in a statically indeterminate structure, surrounding members and supports restrain these free deformations.

That restraint produces **member fixed-end forces**.

Connection to Support Settlement

The mechanics are very similar to support settlement:

- A member has some **free deformation** it would like to undergo
- The structure restrains that deformation
- Restraining it creates a **fixed-end force vector**

The main difference is the coordinate system in which the effect is most naturally described:

- **Support settlement** is usually prescribed in the **global** system
- **Temperature changes** are usually defined in the **local member** system
- **Fabrication errors** are also usually defined in the **local member** system

Core Idea

We first determine the **free local end displacements** caused by the temperature change.

Then we ask:

> *What local end forces would be required to suppress those displacements?*

That force vector is the local thermal fixed-end force vector:

$$\mathbf{q}^H$$

This is exactly the same superposition logic used earlier for member loads and support settlement.

Notation

H superscript indicates FEFs due to temperature change.

Assume the start node is b and the end node is e.

$$\mathbf{q}^H = \begin{bmatrix} q_1^H \\ q_2^H \\ q_3^H \\ q_4^H \\ q_5^H \\ q_6^H \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} q_{xb}^H \\ q_{yb}^H \\ q_{mb}^H \\ q_{xe}^H \\ q_{ye}^H \\ q_{me}^H \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} N_b^H \\ V_b^H \\ M_b^H \\ N_e^H \\ V_e^H \\ M_e^H \end{bmatrix}$$

We write local fixed-end forces using the convention:

- q_{xb}^H = FEF at node **b** in local **x** (axial) → corresponds to **DOF 1**
- q_{yb}^H = FEF at node **b** in local **y** (shear) → corresponds to **DOF 2**
- q_{mb}^H = FEF at node **b** (moment) → corresponds to **DOF 3**
- q_{xe}^H = FEF at node **e** in local **x** (axial) → corresponds to **DOF 4**
- q_{ye}^H = FEF at node **e** in local **y** (shear) → corresponds to **DOF 5**
- q_{me}^H = FEF at node **e** (moment) → corresponds to **DOF 6**

So the fixed-end force vector is

$$\mathbf{q}^{H,T} = \begin{bmatrix} q_{xb}^H & q_{yb}^H & q_{mb}^H & q_{xe}^H & q_{ye}^H & q_{me}^H \end{bmatrix}^T$$

Part 2 — Temperature Changes: Simply Supported Member

Temperature Field Assumption

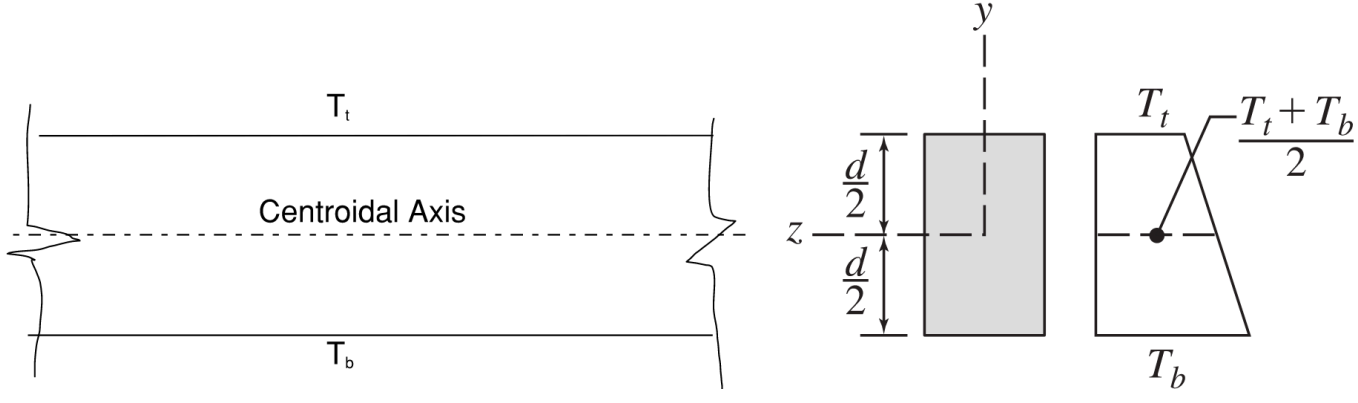
Consider a plane-frame member of length L and depth d.

Assume:

- top surface temperature increase = T_t
- bottom surface temperature increase = T_b
- temperature varies **linearly through the depth**
- temperature does **not** vary along the member length
- coefficient of thermal expansion = α

We assume the member is initially **simply supported**, so it is free to deform without developing end forces.

Temperature Change over Member Depth



Axial Elongation of the Centroidal Axis

The temperature increase at the centroidal axis is the average of the top and bottom values:

$$\frac{T_t + T_b}{2}$$

So the axial elongation of the member is

$$\Delta_H = \alpha \left(\frac{T_t + T_b}{2} \right) L$$

where α is the coefficient of thermal expansion, with units of strain per degree of temperature change (for example, $/^\circ\mathrm{C}$).

This quantity tells us how much a material wants to expand or contract per unit length for each degree of temperature change.

Thus, Δ_H is the **free axial expansion** caused by the **average temperature increase** across the member depth.

Typical values of the coefficient of thermal expansion:

- **Concrete**: $\alpha \approx (8\text{–}12) \times 10^{-6}\ /^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$
- **Structural steel**: $\alpha \approx 12 \times 10^{-6}\ /^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$
- **Wood (Parallel to grain)**: $\alpha \approx (3\text{–}5) \times 10^{-6}\ /^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$
- **Wood (Perpendicular to grain)**: $\alpha \approx (30\text{–}60) \times 10^{-6}\ /^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$
- **Aluminum** $\alpha \approx (22\text{–}24) \times 10^{-6}\ /^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$

End Rotations Due to Temperature Gradient

If $T_b \neq T_t$, the top and bottom fibers elongate by different amounts.

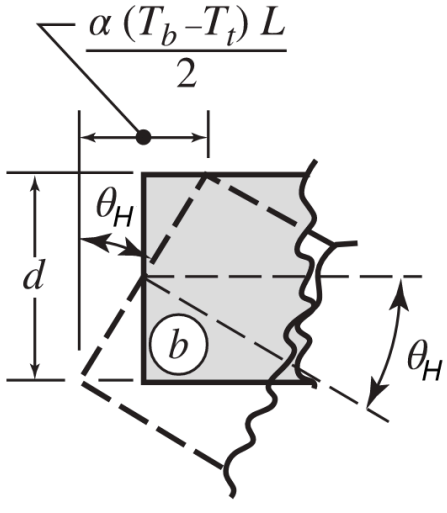
That causes the member to curve.

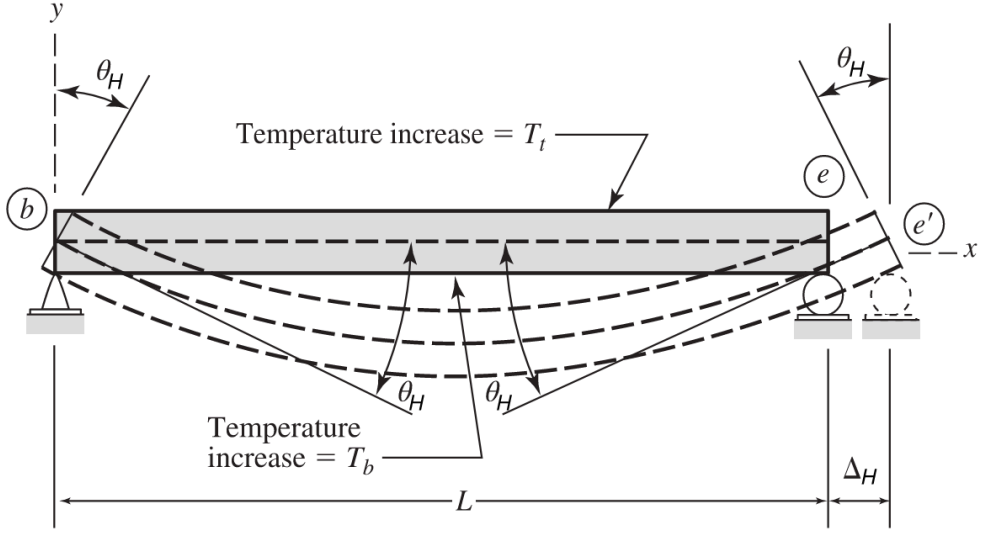
The magnitude of the end rotation (assuming θ is small) is

$$\theta_H \approx \frac{\Delta_b - \Delta_t}{d} = \frac{\alpha(T_b - T_t)L}{2d}$$

Using our sign convention:

- rotation at the **begin node** b is clockwise, so it is **negative**
- rotation at the **end node** e is counterclockwise, so it is **positive**


$\frac{\alpha (T_b - T_t) L}{2}$
θ_H
d
b
θ_H


y
θ_H
θ_H
Temperature increase = T_t
b
e
e'
x
θ_H
θ_H
Temperature increase = T_b
Δ_H
L

Local End Displacement Vector Due to Temperature

Using the local frame element DOF ordering

$$\mathbf{v}^T = \begin{bmatrix} v_1 & v_2 & v_3 & v_4 & v_5 & v_6 \end{bmatrix}^T = \begin{bmatrix} v_{xb} & v_{yb} & \theta_b & v_{xe} & v_{ye} & \theta_e \end{bmatrix}^T$$

the free local end displacement vector, for a simply supported beam, due to temperature change is

$$\mathbf{v}^H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -\theta_H \\ \Delta_H \\ 0 \\ \theta_H \end{bmatrix}$$

where v_3 is negative because the rotation is clockwise at the starting node

substituting the expressions for Δ_H and θ_H,

$$\mathbf{v}^H = \frac{\alpha L}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -(T_b - T_t)/d \\ T_b + T_t \\ 0 \\ (T_b - T_t)/d \end{bmatrix}$$

Reading the Temperature Displacement Vector

$$\mathbf{v}^H = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & -\theta_T & \Delta_T & 0 & \theta_T \end{bmatrix}^T$$

Interpretation:

- no transverse joint translations: $v_2 = v_5 = 0$
- no axial motion at the start node: $v_1 = 0$
- axial expansion appears at the end node: $v_4 = \Delta_T$
- equal and opposite end rotations appear due to curvature: $v_3 = -\theta_T$ and $v_5 = \theta_T$

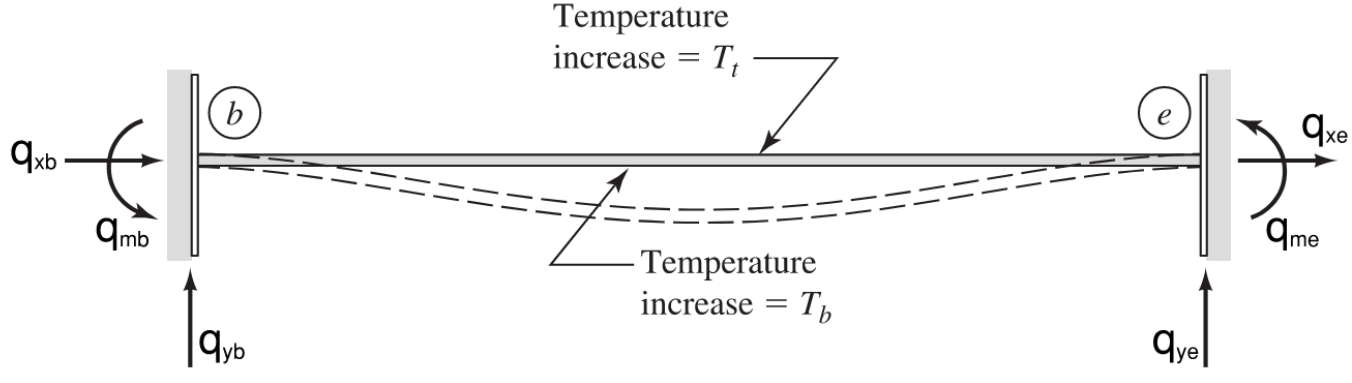
This is a **free deformation vector** for the simply supported member.

Part 3 — Temperature Changes: Equivalent Fixed-End Forces

Superposition Process

(1) Fixed–Fixed Member: Temperature Change

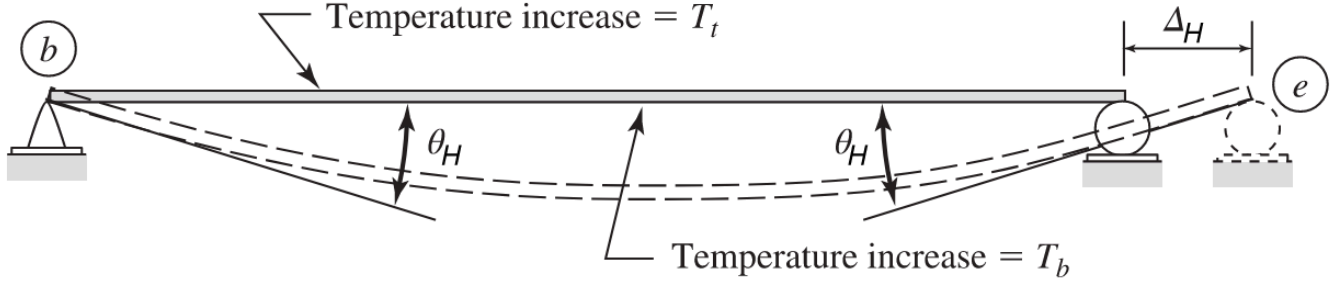
A prismatic frame member is restrained against end displacements and rotations. A uniform temperature increase induces **thermal strain**, which is prevented by the supports, generating **fixed-end forces**.



(2) Simply Supported Member: Temperature Change Only

The same member is now simply supported and subjected to the same temperature increase.

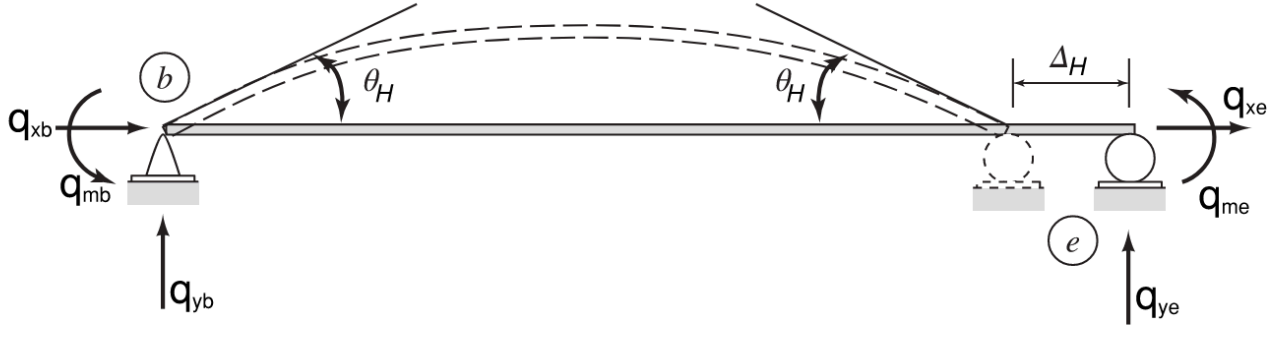
- Ends are free to expand
- **No end forces develop**
- Thermal expansion produces end displacements, v^H



(3) Simply Supported Member: End Forces Only

Apply the **fixed-end forces** from Case (1), but with **no temperature change**.

- Mechanical loading only
- Produces end displacements opposite to thermal expansion



Superposition Principle

The restrained (fixed–fixed) member response equals the sum of two simply supported cases:

$$\text{Fixed member} = \text{Temperature-only} + \text{End-force-only}$$

Displacement form:

$$\mathbf{v}^{(1)} = \mathbf{v}^{(2)} + \mathbf{v}^{(3)}$$

End displacements:

- Fixed member restrained: $\mathbf{v}^{(1)} = \mathbf{0}$
- Simply supported + temperature (free expansion): $\mathbf{v}^{(2)} = \mathbf{v}^{H}$

Compatibility:

$$\mathbf{0} = \mathbf{v}^{H} + \mathbf{v}^{(3)} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \mathbf{v}^{(3)} = -\mathbf{v}^{H}$$

Computing Thermal Fixed-End Forces

Thus, the end forces in (3) that cancel thermal expansion in (2) are obtained from the local stiffness relation:

$$\mathbf{q}^H = \mathbf{k}\left(-\mathbf{v}^H\right)$$

- $\mathbf{q}^H$ — thermal fixed-end force vector
- $\mathbf{v}^H$ — thermal end displacement vector
- $\mathbf{k}$ — local element stiffness matrix

Superposition Summary

To obtain the fixed-end forces for the restrained member:

1. Consider the simply supported member subjected to the temperature change
2. It develops the free end displacements $\mathbf{v}^H$ but no end forces
3. Apply end forces that produce the opposite displacement vector $-\mathbf{v}^H$

Those end forces are exactly the fixed-end forces required to suppress the free thermal deformation.

Local FEFs from the Local Stiffness Matrix

$$\mathbf{q}^H = \mathbf{k}\left(-\mathbf{v}^H\right)$$

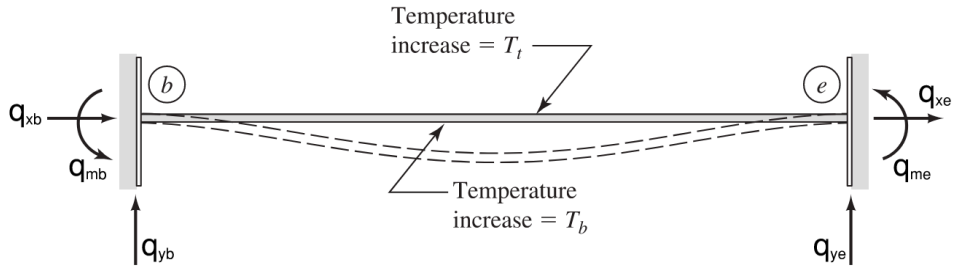
$$= \begin{bmatrix} \frac{EA}{L} & 0 & 0 & -\frac{EA}{L} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{12EI}{L^3} & \frac{6EI}{L^2} & 0 & -\frac{12EI}{L^3} & \frac{6EI}{L^2} \\ 0 & \frac{6EI}{L^2} & \frac{4EI}{L} & 0 & -\frac{6EI}{L^2} & \frac{2EI}{L} \\ -\frac{EA}{L} & 0 & 0 & \frac{EA}{L} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -\frac{12EI}{L^3} & -\frac{6EI}{L^2} & 0 & \frac{12EI}{L^3} & -\frac{6EI}{L^2} \\ 0 & \frac{6EI}{L^2} & \frac{2EI}{L} & 0 & -\frac{6EI}{L^2} & \frac{4EI}{L} \end{bmatrix} \left(-\frac{\alpha L}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -(T_b - T_t)/d \\ T_b + T_t \\ 0 \\ (T_b - T_t)/d \end{bmatrix} \right)$$

Local FEFs Vector

Assume the begin node is b and the end node is e.

$$\mathbf{q}^H = \begin{bmatrix} q_{xb}^H \\ q_{yb}^H \\ q_{mb}^H \\ q_{xe}^H \\ q_{ye}^H \\ q_{me}^H \end{bmatrix} = E\alpha \begin{bmatrix} A(T_b + T_t)/2 \\ 0 \\ I(T_b - T_t)/d \\ -A(T_b + T_t)/2 \\ 0 \\ -I(T_b - T_t)/d \end{bmatrix}$$

Component Form



The thermal fixed-end force expressions are therefore

$$q_{xb}^H = -q_{xe}^H = EA\alpha\left(\frac{T_b + T_t}{2}\right)$$

$$q_{yb}^H = q_{ye}^H = 0$$

$$q_{mb}^H = -q_{me}^H = EI\alpha\left(\frac{T_b - T_t}{d}\right)$$

Special Case: Uniform Temperature Change

If the temperature increase is uniform through the depth,

$$T_b = T_t = T_u$$

then the gradient vanishes, so the bending terms disappear.

The fixed-end force vector becomes

$$\mathbf{q}^H = \begin{bmatrix} EA\alpha T_u \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ -EA\alpha T_u \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Uniform temperature change causes axial restraint force, but no bending moment.

Beams, Frames, and Trusses

These expressions adapt naturally by member type:

- **Plane frame member**: both axial and bending terms may be present
- **Beam member**: axial expansion is free, so only the moment terms matter
- **Truss member**: member ends are free to rotate, so only the axial terms matter

In particular:

- For a **beam**: $q_{xb}^H = 0$ and $q_{xe}^H = 0$
- For a **truss**: $q_{mb}^H = 0$ and $q_{me}^H = 0$

Where Thermal FEFs Enter the DSM Equations

At the element level,

$$\mathbf{q}_i = \mathbf{k}_{l,i}\mathbf{v}_i + \mathbf{q}_i^F + \mathbf{q}_i^H$$

At the assembled global level,

$$\mathbf{f} = \mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{f}^F + \mathbf{f}^\theta$$

or, equivalently,

$$\mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{f}^F - \mathbf{f}^\theta$$

So thermal effects enter the system exactly like other equivalent nodal force terms.

Part 4 — Fabrication Errors Conceptual Framework

What Is a Fabrication Error?

A fabrication error is a small initial deformation or geometric imperfection of a member in its unstressed state.

Common examples include:

- the member being fabricated too long or too short
- the member not being perfectly straight

If the structure must force that imperfect member into the intended geometry, internal forces develop.

Same Superposition Logic as Temperature

The derivation is parallel to the thermal case:

1. Determine the member's free end displacements caused by the geometric error
2. Apply equal and opposite end actions to suppress those displacements
3. The required end actions are the fabrication-error fixed-end forces

We will denote these by

$$\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon}$$

Two Common Types of Fabrication Error

In this lecture we consider:

1. **Error in initial member length**
2. **Error in initial member straightness**

These lead to different forms of $\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon}$.

Part 5 — Fabrication Errors: Fixed-End Force Expressions

Error in Initial Member Length

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Placeholder for member too long by an amount e_a

Fabrication Error in Member Length

Suppose the design length is L, but the unstressed fabricated length is

$$L + e_a$$

with $e_a > 0$ meaning the member is too long.

To fit the member between supports separated by distance L, the structure must compress it axially.

That induces the local fabrication-error fixed-end force vector

$$\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon,a} = \begin{bmatrix} EAe_a/L \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ -EAe_a/L \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Component Form for Length Error

$$N_b^{\varepsilon,a} = -N_e^{\varepsilon,a} = \frac{EA}{L} e_a$$

$$V_b^{\varepsilon,a} = V_e^{\varepsilon,a} = 0$$

$$M_b^{\varepsilon,a} = M_e^{\varepsilon,a} = 0$$

This expression also applies directly to truss members, since the effect is purely axial.

Error in Initial Member Straightness

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Placeholder for member with initial bend e_b at distance l_1 from the left end, with $l_2 = L - l_1$

End Rotations Caused by the Initial Bend

Let the initial straightness error be e_b, occurring at a point that divides the member into lengths l_1 and l_2, with

$$L = l_1 + l_2$$

Then the corresponding end rotations are

$$\theta_b = \frac{e_b}{l_1} \qquad \theta_e = \frac{e_b}{l_2}$$

Using our local sign convention:

- the begin-end rotation is clockwise, so it enters as negative
- the end-node rotation is counterclockwise, so it enters as positive

Local End Displacement Vector Due to Straightness Error

For a beam/frame member, the local end displacement vector due to the initial bend is

$$\mathbf{v}_i^{\varepsilon,b} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -\theta_b \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ \theta_e \end{bmatrix} = e_b \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ -1/l_1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ 1/l_2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Local FEF Vector Due to Straightness Error

The corresponding local fixed-end force vector is

Component Form for Straightness Error

$$\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon,b} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \frac{6EIe_b}{L^2 l_1 l_2}(l_2 - l_1) \\ \frac{2EIe_b}{L l_1 l_2}(2l_2 - l_1) \\ 0 \\ \frac{6EIe_b}{L^2 l_1 l_2}(l_2 - l_1) \\ \frac{6EIe_b}{L^2 l_1 l_2}(l_2 - l_1) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$N_b^{\varepsilon,b} = N_e^{\varepsilon,b} = 0$$

$$V_b^{\varepsilon,b} = -V_e^{\varepsilon,b} = \frac{2EIe_b}{Ll_1l_2}(2l_2 - l_1)$$

$$M_b^{\varepsilon,b} = \frac{2EIe_b}{Ll_1l_2}(2l_2 - l_1)$$

$$M_e^{\varepsilon,b} = \frac{2EIe_b}{Ll_1l_2}(l_2 - 2l_1)$$

Since the straightness error is assumed small, it produces no axial deformation, only bending-type restraint effects.

Total Fabrication-Error FEFs

If multiple fabrication-error sources are present, their local fixed-end force vectors add:

$$\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon} = \mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon,a} + \mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon,b} + \cdots$$

So fabrication error is treated just like any other equivalent nodal load source.

Part 6 — DSM Implementation

Notation Summary

Local equivalent nodal force vectors:

$$\mathbf{q}_i^F \quad \text{member-load FEFs}$$

$$\mathbf{q}_i^\theta \quad \text{temperature-change FEFs}$$

$$\mathbf{q}_i^\varepsilon \quad \text{fabrication-error FEFs}$$

Total local end force equation:

$$\mathbf{q}_i = \mathbf{k}_{l,i}\mathbf{v}_i + \mathbf{q}_i^F + \mathbf{q}_i^\theta + \mathbf{q}_i^\varepsilon$$

Global Assembly Statement

After transformation and assembly,

$$\mathbf{f} = \mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{f}^F + \mathbf{f}^\theta + \mathbf{f}^\varepsilon$$

or, in solved form,

$$\mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{f}^F - \mathbf{f}^\theta - \mathbf{f}^\varepsilon$$

So the implementation pattern is the same one we have already used throughout DSM.

Implementation Steps

1. Build each element local stiffness matrix $\mathbf{k}_{l,i}$
2. Compute any element-level vectors $\mathbf{q}_i^F$, $\mathbf{q}_i^\theta$, $\mathbf{q}_i^\varepsilon$
3. Transform to global coordinates
4. Assemble the global equivalent nodal force vectors
5. Solve the global system

$$\mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{f}^F - \mathbf{f}^\theta - \mathbf{f}^\varepsilon$$

6. Perform the backward pass to recover local element end forces

Coding Example Placeholder

A natural coding example here would:

- define a frame element
- compute $\mathbf{q}_i^{\theta}$ for a temperature gradient
- compute $\mathbf{q}_i^{\varepsilon}$ for an initial fabrication error
- assemble these into the global system
- compare the resulting reactions and member-end forces

Add a short numerical frame example here in the same style as your Lecture 9 settlement notebook.

Wrap-Up

Temperature changes and fabrication errors are handled in DSM as **equivalent nodal force effects**.

For temperature changes:

- average temperature produces axial restraint force
- temperature gradient produces end moments

For fabrication errors:

- length error produces axial restraint force
- straightness error produces shear/moment restraint effects

At the element level:

$$\mathbf{q}_i = \mathbf{k}_{l,i}\mathbf{v}_i + \mathbf{q}_i^F + \mathbf{q}_i^\theta + \mathbf{q}_i^\varepsilon$$

At the global level:

$$\mathbf{K}\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{f} - \mathbf{f}^F - \mathbf{f}^\theta - \mathbf{f}^\varepsilon$$